

THE DIVIDED TRUTH



LEILA KABIR FERNANDES

Wife and Son

- The reason being attributed for my support is the most crass: money.
- He was living in a dingy room with no professional or personal care.
- Power of attorney should not have been given to Jaya without asking us.
- He was under the impression that he had no money. It was all Jaya's.

“George was being abused. How can a man who cannot walk or talk be made to fight elections? If Jaya cared for him how could she push him?”

LEILA KABIR FERNANDES



JAYA JAITLEY

Jaya and the Fernandes brothers

- Where were they for 25 years? They have been asking about his assets.
- Jaya visited him twice a day. He was being examined by AIIMS doctors.
- His cheques were bouncing because his signatures were not tallying.
- Money only withdrawn for his daily needs. Jaya was not sole signatory.

“I have been his closest confidante in public life since 1984. I have, at different times, managed his party, his work and his home.”

JAYA JAITLEY

of his household. As his condition deteriorated, and his cheques began to bounce as his signatures were not tallying, a power of attorney was drawn up on March 21, 2009, in favour of Jaitly and Freddie D'Sa, a trusted friend. This did not go down well with both Leila and Sean. “The next of kin should have been consulted before someone is given power of attorney. It should have been fairly easy to contact me,” Sean told INDIA TODAY. As with most family feuds, this one too is about money and control.

The crumpled kurtas notwithstanding, Fernandes was worth

nearly Rs 13 crore after the sale of a seven-acre ancestral plot on the outskirts of Bangalore. His brother Richard says that he along with other brothers Paul, Michael and Aloysius gave up their rights on this. In June last year, Fernandes summoned his lawyer Abhijat. “He told me that for the first time in his life he had some money, and asked me to identify some charitable institutes,” says Abhijat. According to the brothers, it was only after this sale that Leila and Sean began showing an active interest in Fernandes. “Their visits became more frequent,” Richard points out,

SOCIALIST WEALTH

NELAMANGALA ON OUTSKIRTS OF BANGALORE

Rs 12.45 crore

An ancestral plot in Nelamangala which was sold for Rs 15.50 crore (of which Rs 3.05 crore was paid in tax). His brothers have signed away their rights on it. Sale was finalised four months ago.

6/105 KAUSHALYA PARK, HAUZ KHAS

Rs 8 crore

The ground floor and basement in the name of *The Other Side*, a magazine started by Fernandes and Leila but defunct since 1998. First and second floors in the name of Bombay Labour Union and Municipal Mazdoor Union.

RICHARD, ALOYSIUS, PAUL, MICHAEL AND GEORGE FERNANDES



BUNGALOW IN BANGALORE

Rs 50 lakh

Fernandes got Rs 50 lakh as his share from the sale of an ancestral bungalow in Richmond Town which was sold in 2006-07 (seen in picture). All the brothers took their share in this property.

adding, “as did their enquires about his assets”. An angry Leila retorts, “The reason being attributed for my support to George is the most crass in the world: money. It is terrible.”

This public battle between political heirs and immediate family is not new to Indian politics, the most recent being Mayawati's quarrel with Kanshi Ram's relatives for her mentor's legacy. Unlike Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Bhairon Singh Shekhawat or even the late Chandra Shekhar who had family members attending to them, Fernandes's case is different and, as some would say, more vulnerable. His